PAU Anglès

Sample writing topics

Opinion essay

In our country, young people tend to live with their parents for much longer than they do in other European countries or in the United States. Write an **opinion essay** analyzing the reasons why you think this may be so.

Reality television is extremely popular in many countries. Why are reality shows so successful? Write an **opinion essay**.

For & against essay

Do you shop online, or do you like to go to stores? Does the type of product you are looking for make a difference in your decision? Are online stores fair competition for "real" stores? Write a **for & against essay** in which you discuss some of the advantages and disadvantages of online shopping.

In many places, such as Canada and most states in the United States, the minimum driving age is 16. The legal driving age for automobiles in most European countries is 18. Write a **for & against** essay about lowering the legal driving age in Spain to 16.

e-mail

Cinemas in many towns and cities across the country are closing because of a lack of public. Imagine that the only cinema left in your town is about to close. Write an **email** to your local newspaper arguing in favor of keeping the cinema open.

Imagine you are an exchange student from Shanghai living in Catalonia. Write an **email** to your family in China in which you talk about your experience here.

Narrative

Write a **narrative** about a bad travel experience you have had. Give as many details as possible about places, people and things that went wrong, and how it all ended up. You may include some funny anecdotes, if there were any.

Write a **narrative** about a day you wish to go back to. Explain what happened and why it was such a special day.

Description

Describe the best teacher you have ever had. Make sure you include details about his/her appearance, his/her personality, his/her teaching methods and the way s/he made you feel.

Write a **description** of your hometown. Give as many details as possible about its places and people and about any local festivities that are held there.

Review

You have been invited to be part of the team writing pieces for your local newspaper and will be in charge of the entertainment section. Write a **review** about a television show now available on streaming platforms that may be interesting for young people.

You like to describe yourself as a foodie and want to contribute to a magazine about restaurants in your area. Write a **review** about the best restaurant that you have ever visited with your friends or family.

Writing criteria

Please take the following sentences as just EXAMPLES that need to be present consistently throughout the writing exercise to obtain the suggested marks. As indicated in the regulations, difficulties related to dyslexia are taken into account in the assessment of spelling, vocabulary and the structure of sentences.

GRAMMAR: 1 point

- Sentences that don't make any sense or that contain many errors: 0-0.1

(1) Reclamations, change, or devolution of all my money. I have spend.
(2) You must be send all the command again.

- Very simple structures and serious, frequent and systematic mistakes: 0.2-0.4

(3) Adjectives after nouns, plural adjectives, agreement errors, no subjects, bare forms…

- Some/Few errors, very simple structures and little variation: 0.5-0.6

(4) I would like to go to that paradise with my family and friends and relax.

- Some errors but more elaborate and varied structures: 0.7-0.8

(5) I am of the opinion that the people should protest against it to guarantee the human rights of the workers.

- Very few/No errors (or a very occasional lapsus), elaborate structures: 0.9-1

(6) As the Western world becomes culturally more and more dynamic and diverse, fashion has to adapt itself to the rapidly changing market.
(7) Countries such as China or Vietnam allow this to happen by not putting any restrictions on the fast fashion companies.

VOCABULARY: 1 point

- Inexistent/senseless vocabulary; many basic errors; serious spelling mistakes: 0.1-0.2

(1) The fridge is braken and the wather font not shoot.

- Repetitive, simple vocabulary, errors; spelling mistakes: 0.3-0.4

(2) That place is so nice, the beach in front. The restaurants were so nice and I like the sea and the peple.

- Simple vocabulary but used (generally) correctly: 0.5-0.6

(3) Fast fashion is cheap and young girls like it.

- Elaborate and varied vocabulary (might contain errors): 0.7-0.8

(4) Fast fashion is considered to be affordable, but this is an unfair believe.

- Complex, elaborate, varied vocabulary without errors (or occasional lapsus): 0.9-1

(5) Since we are risking the continuity of human existence, we must definitely put an end to it.
(6) It is necessary to acknowledge the benefits and drawbacks of fast fashion.

COHESION: 1 point

- Use of paragraphs (well-structured paragraphs that contain more than one sentence).
- Punctuation
- (In)correct use of connectors, conjunctions, complex sentences (to be assessed together with Grammar):

(1) Nowadays I didn't visit that place yet.
(2) Although, there are dangers everywhere.

- Repetitive ideas and lack of organisation are also assessed here:

(3) People enjoy travelling for many reasons. Some people like visiting new places. Travelling can also be expensive. Moreover, it is time-consuming. Travelling teaches people about different cultures.

ADEQUACY AND COHERENCE: 1 point

- (Ir)relevant content
    (1) Sentences which are used as pre-learned long chunks which are not relevant or pertinent should be penalised in terms of content (ir)relevance/not taken into account in the number of words (this doesn't apply to connectors or short expressions).
- (Dis)organised content.
- (In)adequate register according to genre (this is also assessed in Vocabulary).
- Title is not obligatory.
- Contractions can be used.
- (Un)clear, (im)mature thoughts. The following examples illustrate childish, immature thoughts:

    (1) The important is to have fun and gain all the money possible.
    (2) Fast fashion makes girls happy because they can buy more clothes.